

Two games, two methods

Hole punching and cube counting are the two you own first. They are procedures, not talent, which is exactly why they are worth the most to you right now. Everything else waits until these are steady.

Hole punching: the grid method

Draw the grid every single time. Even when you think you can see the answer, especially then. The whole point is to take the work out of your head and put it on the paper, so nothing depends on you holding four folds in memory at once.

1. **Draw a 4 by 4 grid.** Sixteen boxes. Do this before you look at the folds.
2. **Hole.** Mark where the punch goes on the folded paper. A circle, not a dot.
3. **Fold.** Find the fold line. It is always along the edge of the paper that moved.
4. **Reflect.** Mirror the hole across that fold line. Only holes on the piece that moved reflect.
5. **Check.** Work backwards through the folds, one at a time, in reverse order.

THE RULE PEOPLE GET WRONG

Only holes on the moving piece of paper reflect. A hole sitting on the part that never moved stays exactly where it is.

RIGHT TO LEFT

Work the folds right to left, the reverse of how they were made. Same direction every time so it becomes automatic.

Cube counting: the T chart

One rhythm, every time, and you never recount: **bottom to top, front to back, left to right.**

1. **Draw the T chart** with rows 0 through 5, one row per number of painted sides.
2. **Number the cubes** in the figure, following the rhythm. Every cube gets a number, including the ones you cannot fully see.
3. **Count the cube on top next**, even a floating one.
4. **Tally** each cube into its row as you go. Finish a row of the figure before moving on.

THE BOTTOM FACE

The face sitting on the table is not painted. That is the single most common miscount.

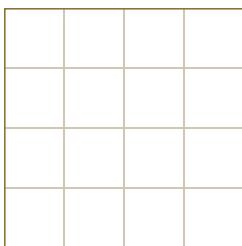
Target on both: 13 to 15 out of 15. These two carry the section.

Built from your session on September 10, 2026. Print this and keep it next to you while you drill.

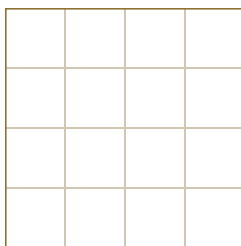
PRACTICE

Hole punching grids

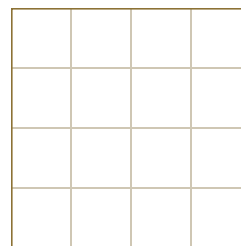
Print this page. One grid per question. Draw before you decide.



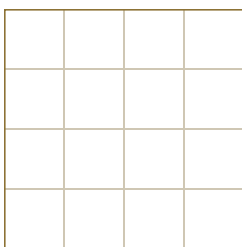
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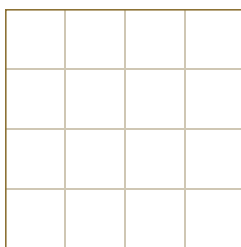
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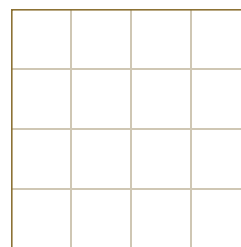
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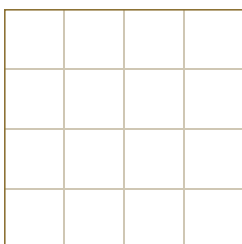
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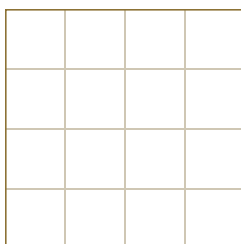
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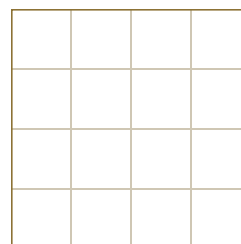
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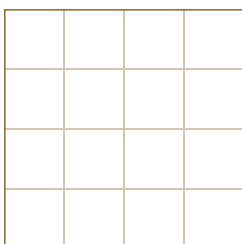
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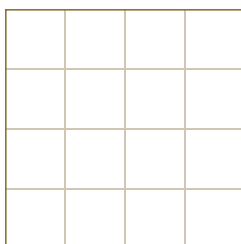
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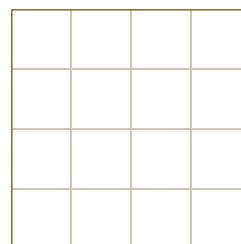
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PRACTICE

Cube counting T charts

One chart per figure. Number every cube, then tally as you go.

SIDES	CUBES	SIDES	CUBES	SIDES	CUBES	SIDES	CUBES
0		0		0		0	
1		1		1		1	
2		2		2		2	
3		3		3		3	
4		4		4		4	
5		5		5		5	
SIDES	CUBES	SIDES	CUBES	SIDES	CUBES	SIDES	CUBES
0		0		0		0	
1		1		1		1	
2		2		2		2	
3		3		3		3	
4		4		4		4	
5		5		5		5	